

HOROLOGICAL MASTER COLLECTION SERIES

PART I

GRAND SEIKO

Illustrated Collector's Field Guide

MASTER COLLECTION GUIDE | 2026 EDITION - REVISION 2 | AUGUST 2026

15 collector cards + the Canon | 4 owned foundation pieces | market bands validated August 2026

The precision quest, told one engine at a time - one coherent Grand Seiko story.

COLLECTION ARCHITECTURE

The thesis

Build a compact history of Grand Seiko told one engine at a time: the precision quest from the chronometer-contest hi-beats through V.F.A., quartz, 9F, Spring Drive and 9SA5 to U.F.A. Design and dial craft ride along on watches already earning their slot. Owned pieces remain inside the historical sequence, no chapter is told twice, and every future purchase must contribute a chapter not already represented.

OWNED FOUNDATION

- 4520-7010 - manual Hi-Beat
- 6145-8000 - automatic Hi-Beat
- SBGE285 - Spring Drive GMT / E9
- SLGB005 - Spring Drive U.F.A.

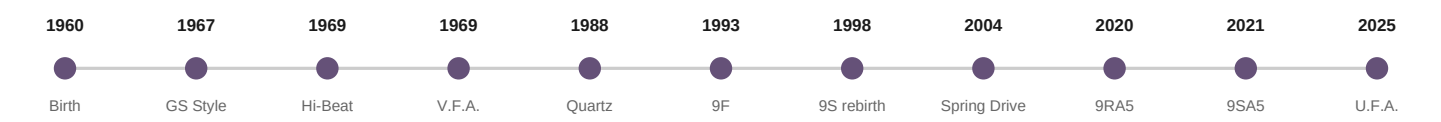
NEXT CHAPTERS

- 44GS 4420-9000 - design language
- SBGA011 - Spring Drive icon
- SLGH005 - 9SA5 architecture
- First J14070 - genesis
- SLGA015 - 9RA5 five-day + diver

TWO-PART STRUCTURE

Part A (the cards that follow) is the acquisition plan: fifteen slots, every one buyable and force-ranked. Part B - The Canon - holds the watches the collection acknowledges but does not chase: Kodo, the Micro Artist platinum pieces and the SLGH002. They carry no rank and consume no capital.

COLLECTION SPINE



COLLECTION RULES

1. A future Grand Seiko should add a chapter, not merely another beautiful dial. 2. A Canon watch enters the plan only when a papered example inside budget surfaces - no rank numbers pretend otherwise.

Where I would focus next. Ordering is market-urgency times narrative weight; bands are validated against sold transactions (Aug 2026), not dealer askings. Vintage buys route through the JDM channel where possible - Japanese exits run 20-40% under Western asks.

1. 44GS 4420-9000

The design-language cornerstone. Fixed supply, rising demand, condition is the collection - buy the sharp case first.

10 / 10
2. SBGA011 Original Snowflake

Appreciation in progress; double-logo supply only shrinks. Buy inside 6-12 months at \$2,900-3,700.

9 / 10
3. SLGH005 White Birch

The 9SA5 chapter in its canonical wearable form. Buy used at \$5,800-7,000 - depreciation is already spent.

8 / 10
4. Grand Seiko First J14070

Genesis. Vetted-dealer-only (redials rampant); a patient one-to-two-year hunt at \$3,600-6,500.

7.5 / 10
5. SLGA015 Evolution 9 Diver

Two missing chapters in one slot: the 9RA5 five-day Spring Drive generation and the diver line.

7 / 10
6. 62GS 6245-9000

First GS automatic, still priced like a footnote. JDM channel; \$1,400-2,600.

6 / 10
7. SBGX261 - the real 9F

The 1993 chapter told by the caliber itself, not a commemorative. Always available - buy cheap.

5 / 10
8. SBGR001 + 95GS SBGS001

Real chapters, zero urgency, zero appreciation. Buy whenever, never at dealer-ask tops.

4 & 3 / 10

STANDING ORDERS - OFF THE SEQUENTIAL LIST

61GS V.F.A. 6185-8020: papered, serial-coherent examples only, hard cap \$15,000. Authentication protocol: movement photos, case/movement number coherence, specialist inspection contingency - standard 6145 movements in V.F.A. cases are the most common Grand Seiko fake. The appreciation engine of the plan, but only as the right watch. SLGW003 (stretch): the 2024 manual hi-beat descendant of the owned 45GS, ~\$10-11k; alternate SLGC001 Tentagraph at or under \$9,500 if the chronograph chapter must exist.

ORIGINS & GOLDEN AGE | #01

Grand Seiko First

J14070 / Cal. 3180



Photo: Timeanagram

DATES 1960-1963
CALIBER 3180 - manual wind
DIMENSIONS ~35.0 mm diameter; ~10.5 mm thick

WHY IT BELONGS
Genesis. The first Grand Seiko and the opening statement of the brand's pursuit of precision, legibility, durability and refinement.

TARGET / MARKET

\$3,600-6,500

PRIORITY

7.5 / 10

RECOMMENDED VARIANT / BUYING NOTE
14K gold-filled J14070 with original dial, crown and caseback medallion. The highest authenticity-risk buy in the guide - vetted specialist dealers only, budget the top of the band and the patience of a year. A redialed First is a \$1,500 watch wearing a \$6,000 price.

ORIGINS & GOLDEN AGE | #02

44GS

4420-9000 / Cal. 4420B



Photo: Alpha Omega

DATES 1967-1968/69
CALIBER 4420B - manual wind
DIMENSIONS ~37.8 mm diameter; ~10 mm thick

WHY IT BELONGS
The design milestone. This reference established the Grand Seiko Style: broad planes, razor-like facets and deliberate light-shadow geometry.

TARGET / MARKET

\$2,800-4,500

PRIORITY

10 / 10

RECOMMENDED VARIANT / BUYING NOTE
The sharpest honest case you can find, with intact medallion and original dial. Over-polished zaratsu cases are permanently impaired and are most of the supply - the 30-40% sharp-case premium buys the only version that appreciates.

ORIGINS & GOLDEN AGE | #03

OWNED FOUNDATION

45GS - OWNED

4520-7010 / Cal. 4520A



Photo: Illustrated reference; specs cross-checked to Timeanagram

DATES c. 1969-1970
CALIBER 4520A - manual wind, 36,000 vph
DIMENSIONS 36.8 mm diameter; ~10 mm thick
WHY IT BELONGS
The vintage technical anchor. A late-1960s manual Hi-Beat carrying first-generation 36,000-vph precision in a softer C-line case. Slot one of the precision spine.

TARGET / MARKET	PRIORITY
OWNED; private-sale market \$1,000-1,600	OWNED

RECOMMENDED VARIANT / BUYING NOTE
Keep this exact 4520-7010: clean no-date dial, original case geometry, medallion. Recorded honestly: \$1,850 paid was dealer-retail, above the private-sale band - see Methodology.

ORIGINS & GOLDEN AGE | #04

62GS

6245-9000 / Cal. 6245A

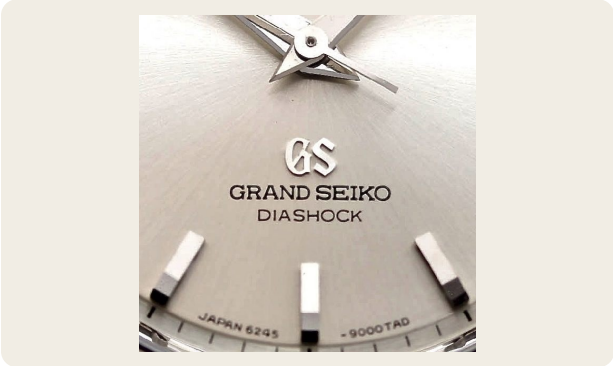


Photo: Timeline.watch

DATES 1966-1968
CALIBER 6245A - automatic
DIMENSIONS ~36.5 mm diameter; ~11.5 mm thick
WHY IT BELONGS
Grand Seiko's first automatic watch and the bezel-free case architecture still echoed in modern GS design - the design counterpoint to the 44GS, still priced pre-discovery.

TARGET / MARKET	PRIORITY
\$1,400-2,600	6 / 10

RECOMMENDED VARIANT / BUYING NOTE
Date-only 6245-9000 with a crisp case and correct lion medallion, cleaner than the day-date 6246. Buy through the JDM channel; the \$3,000 Western dealer ask is retail, not the market.

ORIGINS & GOLDEN AGE | #05

OWNED FOUNDATION

61GS Hi-Beat - OWNED

6145-8000 / serial 800578



Photo: Marc supplied seller image

DATES October 1968
CALIBER 6145A - automatic 36,000 vph
DIMENSIONS ~36.5-37.0 mm; ~12 mm thick

WHY IT BELONGS
Japan's first automatic 10-beat Grand Seiko. The early-dial example is the perfect automatic counterpart to the manual-wind 45GS - the Suwa answer to Daini's watch.

TARGET / MARKET

ACQUIRED AUG 2026 - \$1,000 (fair market, validated)

PRIORITY

OWNED

RECOMMENDED VARIANT / BUYING NOTE
Keep the early Grand Seiko dial / Grand Seiko rotor configuration, service paperwork, signed buckle and spare mainspring together as provenance.

STANDING ORDER

ORIGINS & GOLDEN AGE | #06

61GS V.F.A.

6185-8020 / Cal. 6185A



Photo: FireKids

DATES 1969-early 1970s
CALIBER 6185A - automatic 36,000 vph V.F.A.
DIMENSIONS ~37.0 mm diameter; ~11.5 mm thick

WHY IT BELONGS
The vintage mechanical precision summit and the historical mirror of the owned U.F.A. Also the most faked Grand Seiko in existence - which is why it is a standing order, not a hunt-list item.

TARGET / MARKET

\$9,000-16,000; early Suwa
\$13,000-18,000+ (cap \$15,000)

PRIORITY

6.5 / 10

RECOMMENDED VARIANT / BUYING NOTE
Papered, serial-coherent examples only: movement photos, matching case/movement numbers, specialist inspection contingency. Priority becomes 10/10 for the right watch under the cap; walk away from everything else.

QUARTZ & THE REBIRTH | #07

95GS Quartz

SBGS001 / 9581-7000



Photo: Yahoo Japan auction archive

DATES 1988-early 1990s
CALIBER 9581 - high-accuracy quartz
DIMENSIONS ~33.5 mm diameter; ~7.7 mm thick

WHY IT BELONGS
The 1988 return of Grand Seiko in quartz form - the historically exact 95GS chapter, and the best narrative-per-dollar ratio in Grand Seiko collecting.

TARGET / MARKET

\$450-800

PRIORITY

3 / 10

RECOMMENDED VARIANT / BUYING NOTE
Steel SBGS001 from the first generation with original crown and hardware. Zero urgency and zero appreciation - buy whenever, never from a Western dealer at a premium.

QUARTZ & THE REBIRTH | #08

NEW CHAPTER - AUG 2026

The 9F

SBGX261 / Cal. 9F62



Awaiting reference image

DATES Caliber 1993; SBGX261 2016-present
CALIBER 9F62 - thermocompensated quartz, sealed cabin
DIMENSIONS 37.0 mm diameter; ~11.7 mm thick

WHY IT BELONGS
The real 9F chapter: 1993's sealed-cabin, twin-pulse, backlash-adjusted quartz built as an end in itself - the actual hinge of the rebirth this guide previously skipped between 1988 and 1998.

TARGET / MARKET

\$2,000-2,500 (est.)

PRIORITY

5 / 10

RECOMMENDED VARIANT / BUYING NOTE
Standard-production SBGX261, the canonical 37 mm 9F62. Alternate: SBGP011 (2020, 9F85 with independent hour hand) if the caliber's own evolution appeals. Replaces the commemorative SBGT241 - collect the building, not the plaque.

QUARTZ & THE REBIRTH | #09

Mechanical Rebirth

SBGR001 / Cal. 9S55



Photo: EveryWatch

DATES 1998-early 2000s
CALIBER 9S55 - automatic
DIMENSIONS ~37.0 mm diameter; ~11.3 mm thick

WHY IT BELONGS
The 1998 rebirth of mechanical Grand Seiko and the start of the modern 9S lineage. Quiet-looking, historically enormous.

TARGET / MARKET

\$1,700-2,500

PRIORITY

4 / 10

RECOMMENDED VARIANT / BUYING NOTE
Early double-logo SBGR001, ideally full set. The chapter matters; the watch will always be available - solds cluster \$1,600-2,000, so never pay the \$3,000 dealer ask.

MODERN GRAND SEIKO EMERGES | #10

Original Snowflake

SBGA011 / Cal. 9R65



Photo: EveryWatch

DATES 2005-2017
CALIBER 9R65 - automatic Spring Drive
DIMENSIONS 41.0 x 48.6 x 12.7 mm

WHY IT BELONGS
The watch that made Spring Drive visually and emotionally synonymous with Grand Seiko - and now the sole teller of the 9R65 chapter, retiring the SBGA001 slot. A modern icon with real historical weight.

TARGET / MARKET

\$2,900-3,700

PRIORITY

9 / 10

RECOMMENDED VARIANT / BUYING NOTE
SBGA011 specifically, not SBGA211: the pre-2017 double-logo dial is the historically expressive version. Appreciation in progress - buy inside 6-12 months; JDM solds run \$2,550-2,700.

THE NEW TECHNICAL AGE | #11

White Birch

SLGH005 / Cal. 9SA5



Photo: Grand Seiko

DATES 2021-present
CALIBER 9SA5 - automatic Hi-Beat 36,000 vph, 80h
DIMENSIONS 40.0 x 47.0 x 11.7 mm

WHY IT BELONGS
The wearable flagship of the 9SA5 architecture and Evolution 9 design language - and the canonical form of the chapter, retiring the LE-100 SLGH002 to the Canon.

TARGET / MARKET

\$5,800-7,000

PRIORITY

8 / 10

RECOMMENDED VARIANT / BUYING NOTE
Regular-production SLGH005, lightly used and unpolished. Clean used examples at \$5,500-6,000 carry near-zero remaining depreciation - the safe slot in the plan.

THE NEW TECHNICAL AGE | #12

STRETCH SLOT

Birch Bark Manual

SLGW003 / Cal. 9SA4



Awaiting reference image

DATES 2024-present
CALIBER 9SA4 - manual wind Hi-Beat 36,000 vph, 80h
DIMENSIONS 38.6 mm diameter; 9.95 mm thick

WHY IT BELONGS
The 2024 manual-wind hi-beat in a 44GS-lineage Evolution 9 case - the direct modern descendant of the owned 45GS. The internal rhyme that makes the collection read as composed rather than assembled.

TARGET / MARKET

\$10,000-11,000 (est.)

PRIORITY

5.5 / 10

RECOMMENDED VARIANT / BUYING NOTE
High-Intensity Titanium SLGW003. Alternate for this slot: SLGC001 Tentagraph at or under \$9,500 if the chronograph chapter must exist - realized Tentagraph prices cluster \$8,000-9,500.

THE NEW TECHNICAL AGE | #13

NEW CHAPTER - AUG 2026

Evolution 9 Diver

SLGA015 / Cal. 9RA5



Awaiting reference image

DATES 2022-present
CALIBER 9RA5 - Spring Drive five-day, 120h, +/-10 s/mo
DIMENSIONS 43.8 mm; High-Intensity Titanium; 200 m

WHY IT BELONGS
One slot, two previously missing chapters: the 9RA5 five-day Spring Drive generation - the largest Spring Drive advance since 2004 - and the celebrated diver line, both absent from every earlier edition.

TARGET / MARKET	PRIORITY
\$8,000-9,500	7 / 10

RECOMMENDED VARIANT / BUYING NOTE
SLGA015 Evolution 9 diver. Swap candidate: SLGA007 Omiwatari if dial craft outranks the diver chapter - same movement generation, weaker sports coverage.

THE NEW TECHNICAL AGE | #14

OWNED FOUNDATION

Mist Flake GMT - OWNED

SBGE285 / Cal. 9R66



Photo: Illustrated reference; specs verified to Grand Seiko

DATES 2022-present
CALIBER 9R66 - automatic Spring Drive GMT
DIMENSIONS 41.0 x 48.3 x 13.9 mm

WHY IT BELONGS
The modern practical anchor: Evolution 9, High-Intensity Titanium, true traveler GMT and mature Spring Drive in one highly wearable package.

TARGET / MARKET	PRIORITY
OWNED; realized market \$5,500-6,500 (paid ~\$4,950)	OWNED

RECOMMENDED VARIANT / BUYING NOTE
Keep the SBGE285 - it fills the modern Spring Drive GMT / Evolution 9 sport chapter extremely well; no duplicate GMT needed.

THE NEW TECHNICAL AGE | #15

OWNED FOUNDATION

Violet Dawn - OWNED

SLGB005 / Cal. 9RB2



Photo: Grand Seiko

DATES	2025 - LE 1,300
CALIBER	9RB2 Spring Drive U.F.A. - +/-20 sec/year
DIMENSIONS	37.0 x 44.3 x 11.4 mm

WHY IT BELONGS

The U.F.A. precision milestone and the modern endpoint of the accuracy obsession - the anchor of the 4520 to V.F.A. to U.F.A. precision sequence.

TARGET / MARKET	PRIORITY
OWNED; secondary \$8,800-10,200 vs \$11,100 retail	OWNED

RECOMMENDED VARIANT / BUYING NOTE

Keep the full set and enjoy it. Year-one LE J-curve is normal - a five-year-plus hold while the U.F.A. story matures, not a regret.

Collection rule

This open half-card is intentional. The guide remains a living collection map. A future addition should earn this space by adding a genuinely new chapter — an engine or a story not already represented on any card in Part A.

Candidates on file: 57GS 5722-9990 as the Self Dater (first GS date, first stop-seconds) if a sharp original surfaces under \$1,500 · a 45KS King Seiko (~\$500-800) as the physical artifact of the Suwa-Daini rivalry · SLGA007 Omiwatari if dial craft demands its own slot.

Watches the collection acknowledges and would opportunistically consider, kept deliberately outside the acquisition plan: three are allocation-gated or auction-exit-only, and all four together would have consumed 84% of the old roadmap's capital for four chapters the text can carry on its own. Promotion rule: a papered example inside budget surfaces at auction - it enters Part A. Until then, no rank numbers pretend otherwise.



Photo: Grand Seiko

Kodo Constant-Force Tourbillon

SLGT003 / Cal. 9ST1 - 2022, LE 20

First GS mechanical complication: tourbillon and constant force on one axis. No public secondary trade has ever occurred; the piece-unique SLGT001 made \$478,800 at Phillips 2022. Working assumption \$250-325k - unverifiable.



Photo: Grand Seiko

Micro Artist 9R02 Masterpiece

SBGZ001 - 2019, LE 30, platinum

Hand-engraved platinum, hand-finished 9R02. Two public sales ever: ~\$64k (HK 2022) and \$81.9k (Phillips 2023). Realistic requirement \$60-80k, auction-exit-only.

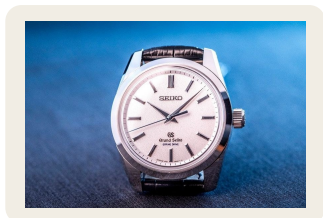


Photo: Time+Tide

Spring Drive 8 Days

SBGD001 / Cal. 9R01 - 2016-17, platinum

First Micro Artist Studio GS. Loupe This sold a first-series example at \$30,989 (Aug 2025) against \$54k+ dealer asks - a \$30-48k watch with brutal bid-ask spread. Same chapter as SBGZ001; one Micro Artist slot is enough, and it lives here.



Photo: Grand Seiko

First 9SA5

SLGH002 - 2020, LE 100, 18K yellow gold

The literal beginning of the 9SA5 era - but the chapter is the caliber, and the White Birch tells it on the wrist. Asking-only market \$26-32k, ~25% under retail, months-long exits.

SOURCES & METHODOLOGY

HISTORICAL BASIS

Milestones and specifications are grounded in Grand Seiko / Seiko historical material, official collection pages and specialist archives, cross-checked against auction records and reputable dealer examples. The vintage chapters are the product of the internal Suwa-Daini rivalry - Daini built the 44GS and 45GS, Suwa the 62GS and 61GS - which is why the chronometer-era watches are great, and why the owned 45GS/61GS pair embodies the competition itself.

MARKET METHODOLOGY

All bands were validated August 2026 against sold and completed transactions (eBay solds, WatchCharts, auction results, Yahoo Japan closed auctions, collector-forum sales) in a seven-agent adversarial review; dealer askings were discounted 10-20% and never treated as market. Bands are working acquisition ranges for the described variant, not appraisals. Vintage purchases route through the JDM channel where practical - Japanese exits run 20-40% under Western asks, offset by redial exposure without a vetted dealer.

VINTAGE BUYING PRINCIPLE & AUTHENTICATION

For 44GS, 45GS, 62GS, 61GS, V.F.A. and the First, case geometry and dial originality are the historical content of the watch: a cheaper polished or redialed example is the more expensive mistake. The J14070 and the V.F.A. carry the highest fake/franken exposure in the catalog - both are vetted-dealer-or-papered-only, with the V.F.A. requiring movement photos and case/movement serial coherence before any money moves.

OWNED-WATCH STATUS

Four owned foundations: 4520-7010, 6145-8000 (October 1968, acquired August 2026 at \$1,000 - validated at fair market), SBGE285 (~\$4,950 paid vs \$5,500-6,500 realized market) and SLGB005 (\$11,100 retail vs ~\$9,200 current secondary - a normal year-one limited-edition curve; hold five years plus). Correction recorded: the 45GS was bought at \$1,850, above its \$1,000-1,600 private-sale band - a dealer-retail purchase, logged honestly so future buys are audited the same way.

SCOPE

This is a single-wearer personal collection: women's and smaller Grand Seiko references are excluded by design, not oversight. The sports chapter is carried by the owned SBGE285 and the SLGA015 slot; the dial-craft story rides on Snowflake, White Birch and the Omiwatari swap option rather than claiming its own slots.

PHOTOGRAPHY POLICY

Reference photography is credited on-card and in the index. Three new cards (SBGX261, SLGW003, SLGA015) await reference images and carry labeled placeholders; two owned references retain clearly labeled illustrations where a local photograph was not yet available.

PHOTOGRAPHY INDEX

Image credits for this edition. Owned-watch photographs are identified where supplied by Marc.

01. Grand Seiko First

Timeanagram

02. 44GS

Alpha Omega

03. 45GS 4520-7010

Illustrated reference / Timeanagram specs

04. 62GS

Timeline.watch

05. 61GS Hi-Beat 6145-8000

Marc supplied seller image

06. 61GS V.F.A.

FireKids

07. 95GS Quartz

Yahoo Japan auction archive

08. The 9F (SBGX261)

Pending

09. Mechanical Rebirth

EveryWatch

10. Original Snowflake

EveryWatch

11. White Birch

Grand Seiko

12. Birch Bark Manual (SLGW003)

Pending

13. Evolution 9 Diver (SLGA015)

Pending

14. Mist Flake GMT

Illustrated reference / Grand Seiko specs

15. Violet Dawn

Grand Seiko

Canon: Kodo

Grand Seiko

Canon: Micro Artist SBGZ001

Grand Seiko

Canon: Spring Drive 8 Days

Time+Tide

Canon: First 9SA5 SLGH002

Grand Seiko